Chapter 14

The Beautiful Elephant Girl

SUMMARY. The elephant girl's husband's younger brother was still in his mother's stomach when his older brother married the elephant girl. After the marriage, the elephant girl's husband brought her to his mother's village to live, and she gave birth to a daughter there. But there were no elderly people living at that village, so the elephant girl and her husband planned to visit his older relatives at other villages to ask for gifts for the child. The elephant girl planned to leave her daughter with a woman there while she and her husband went visiting. The night before they were to leave, the elephant girl and her husband slept at his mother's village.

The mother's stomach grew, and she was about to give birth. In the morning, her older son, the elephant girl's husband, was packing to leave. His mother was grinding ochre and rubbing her stomach with it. Her newborn son jumped straight up out of her stomach, saying, "Mother, rub your hands on my head so that I can go with my older brother." Everyone was astonished, but one of them said, "This is a sky's thing, so just do what he says: let him go on the journey with his older brother." So his mother rubbed him with ochre and fat and he left with his older brother.

At one of the villages of the old people, the husband was requested to bring his daughter so they could see her. He agreed, and they were walking to fetch the child at the other village. As they were walking past an anthill, the younger brother stepped on a thorn and cried, "Ouch, ouch, ouch!" Then he took off his shoes and threw them away, saying they should go off and become vultures that drop down on meat. Then the younger brother said, "Run, older brother, go see what those vultures are dropping on, and get meat for us to eat."

Meanwhile, the older brother's wife, the elephant girl, was wearing

a skin apron with a metal awl stuck in its waistband. The younger brother asked his brother's wife to use the awl to pull out the thorn from his foot. The elephant girl believed what he said and came close. He took the awl and killed her.

The elephant girl had already told her grandmother that she didn't trust her husband's younger brother. She had said, "My thoughts don't agree with a thing that jumps out of its mother's stomach saying it wants to accompany its older brother. So watch well: a little wind will come to you with droplets of my blood, and will stick to your groin. Take the bit of blood and put it into something like a little bowl or a jar." And indeed the little wind with the blood came to the grandmother and stuck to her. The grandmother said in her heart, "Isn't this just what the child said would happen?" She took the blood and put it in a jar, and lived and thought. She said to herself, "If they've already completed what she told me, there's nothing to be done."

Meanwhile, the elephant girl's brothers went to follow her husband and his younger brother, to see if they had arrived safely at the village with their sister. In fact, the older brother had gone off and had not found the vultures, and was returning to where his younger brother was. The younger brother had killed and skinned his older brother's wife, the elephant girl, and had roasted her and was cutting up and eating her fat. The older brother arrived and, not seeing his wife, asked what kind of meat it was. The younger brother told him not to ask so many questions, but just to come and taste the meat. "Why do you call that which is meat, a woman?" asked the younger brother.

The older brother was greatly upset and asked his younger brother how he would manage to remain alive if he ate a piece of his own wife. "Stick with me," said the younger brother, insisting again that it was plain meat. Finally the older brother took a piece and ate it. At that moment the brothers of the elephant girl, having tracked the two, were seen approaching. The younger brother told the anthill to break open so his brother could enter and avoid the anger that was coming his way. The anthill obeyed, and the older brother stepped inside. The anthill closed. The younger brother stood alone outside, and when the elephant girl's brothers tried to stab him, he perched on the points of their spears like the little bird called ǁomhaya. He dodged their spears, perching on their heads, perching on their noses, and perching on their other body parts, and eventually defeated them completely. They left him and went off.

The older brother jumped out of the anthill and the two of them took the meat and went home to their village. The people asked,

"What have you done with the woman whose child is standing over there? What kind of meat is that you are walking around with your stomachs full of? You two have done something very wrong."

Meanwhile the bit of blood stayed in the grandmother's jar and grew. The grandmother put it into a skin bag and it grew some more. It split the bag so she put it into something larger. It grew and split that too. Only the grandmother knew what she was doing and kept her intention, growing the blood into a regular big woman again. Finally the elephant girl was the size of a sack.

One day the women of that village said they would go gathering raisin berries, and they took the child along with them. The grandmother spent the day alone at the village. When the sun was getting low, she spread a reed mat in the shade and took out the elephant girl and set her on the mat. She ground ochre and spread it on her, fixed her and dressed her and hung her with ornaments, and fastened copper rings into her hair. She was the beautiful elephant girl again.

When the women were coming back from gathering, they heard the old woman speaking to someone, and that someone was laughing in response. The child asked, "Who is laughing in the village that sounds just like my dead mother?" The other women thought the child was crazy, but then the elephant girl laughed again and they all began to wonder. They arrived in the village and saw her sitting there. Her daughter cried, "It's my mother!" and dropped down and began to nurse. The other women asked, "Who has done this?" The elephant girl replied, "Granny, of course, Granny alone. The old people give you life."

Another day the two who had killed her came back to the village, and, seeing her, got a fright. But they still wanted to take the elephant girl to visit her in-laws. The grandmother secretly gave her a magical gemsbok horn and told her how to use it when she arrived at the in-laws' village. The elephant girl then left with her husband and his younger brother and they traveled a long distance. As they traveled, the elephant girl kept asking them to let her know before they arrived at the village. She asked about mountains, and riverbeds with water, and what the distance was between where they were and the village they would be visiting. Finally they passed a hill, then a valley of soft sand, and another hill, and came to a village beyond, where small children with clean tummies were playing around and laughing. The brothers told her this was the place.

The elephant girl told them to go ahead of her into the village, that

she wanted to powder herself and then follow them in. When the two brothers had entered the village, she took out her magical gemsbok horn and blew on it, saying "These two brothers and their village shall be broken apart and ruined!" The horn blew down the village, flattened it to the ground. Then the beautiful elephant girl walked home.

SPEAKER. !*Unn*|*obe Morethlwa*

RECORDED. Kauri, Botswana, 1971

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ǁ'a !'hoan o !xodi ǁ'a ha tshin
that man was the elephant girl's younger brother
ha !xodi ǁ'aha !'hoan ǁ'aha tshin
the elephant girl's husband's younger brother
ee
yes
te-ee
and
te ha
and he
ǁ'a !arikxaoma koh
that adolescent
tsau,
he got up,
sa !'hoan ǁ'a sa
with the husband, and they two
ǁae sa mhsi, kohm, o sa hin
took their children, in fact, it was those two
te ka ha
and when he
ha !ari-
the adolescent (word cut off)
!'hoaan to'a ku gu dshauma
that man was marrying the girl
he o !xodi oo, okaa
that was the elephant girl, that was when
ǁ'a !arikxaoma to'a ku n!o'o
that adolescent was hurrying

g!oehsi ooa koh–ha taqe koh sin kxae ha g!u
the shoes did thus–his mother just had him in her stomach
khoea ko ha
(was pregnant with him)
ha sin gea ha taqe g!u n!ang
he was just in his mother's stomach
te ha !o gu ǁ'a dshaua
and his older brother married that woman
te g‡ara ha te gu ha te u ǀxoa
and asked for her and took her and went away with her
te u ge ǀxoa ha ko ha, ha tjuǀho
and went and stayed with her in his, his village
te gǀae
and went
ǁ'akoa te gea ǁ'akoa te gea ǁ'akoa te
there and stayed there and stayed there and
te ǁ'akoa hin tsi ha
and there at that place she
gǁa'ia da'ama ko ǁ'akoa
gave birth to a child there
da'ama o dshauma
the child was a girl
te ha koe te ha
and she was this big and she
ka nǁah ha
left her
dshau ku se da'ama
a woman was looking after the child
koa ju!ae sin koara
where there were no old people
ee, ha, ha ǀ'uisi tjuǀho hin tsi ha n!haeta gea
yes, she was already staying at her, her in-laws' village
ee, te te ǁama ǁ'akoa te
yes, and and from there and
te te
and and
g‡ara u ha ju !aesi
went to ask from his old people
te u ku g‡ara
and went and was asking
xaro tciasi, !oa ha ju !aesi ǁ'a ha tsi
for gifts, telling his old people that he had arrived

n‡ai kxaea da'ama, n‡ai kxaea ha dshau
so that he could cause his child to have things, cause his wife to have things (get gifts given to them)
te ǁ'akaa ha dshau te gea ha ju !aesi tju|ho te ha koe u te
and then his wife stayed at his old people's village and he went off this way and
g!a
arrived back home
te tza
and slept
te ha taqe
and his mother's
g!u !'am
stomach grew
te ha ku nǁuri ka ha ǁamm
and she was about to give birth
te ge
and stayed
te si
and they
ha tza te tsau te gǁaan te tza
he slept and got up and spent the day and slept
te ha khoma te ku abasi |'an ka ha
and in the morning he packed so that he
ce
(could) go back
te ha taqe xai g!oq'in
and his mother ground ochre
g!oq'in
ochre
te ku nǁhom ha
and rubbed her
g!u
stomach
te hahin tse tsaua ha taqe g!u n!ang
and he then jumped out of his mother's stomach
te ha taqe du ha g!u, du ha g!u, du ha g!u te
and his mother did her stomach, did her stomach, did her stomach and
du ǁ'ai te |'an ha !o
made beads and gave (them to) his older brother
te
and
ha ǁama khuin tsi ke te khu g|ai
he came from there and jumped out

ǁama khuin tsi ke te khu gǀai te ko, ”aia, ee”
came from there and jumped out and said, ”mother, yes”
te ko, ”aia, gǂhua a g!ausi ko mi nǀai nǀang mi
and said, ”mother, rub your hands on my head so that I
u ǀxoa mi !o”
can go with my older brother.”
si ko si tam te si nǀui !xau te ko, ”tca o nǀa’an tcia, nǀang i!a sin tsi nǁaahn tam.
they said they were surprised but one of them refused and said, ”this is a sky’s thing, so don’t you all say you’re surprised.
nǀang sin du tca ha hin ku nǁa
just do what he says
da’ama tcia ne m ǀoa ku khu gǀaia ju n!ang ka ku kokxui te i!a hin ku tam ka?
what kind of child is this who jumps out of a person’s stomach and talks and you here are surprised at it?
sin du ha
just do him
nǀang ha gǀae u ua to’a he ha ko ha u ǀxoa ha !o”
let him go on that journey he wants to go on with his older brother”
si koe nǁae
they said this
ee
yes
te ha nǁhoma ha ko ǁ’a g!oq’in, ǁ’a nǀaia ha nǁhoma ha ko ka
and she rubbed him with the ochre, the fat she rubbed him with
te ha !o ku ǁxoba te ha ǁxoba ǀxoa ha !o
and his older brother left and he left with his older brother
te sa u
and they went
te u u u te
and went went went and
ua tjuǀho
went to the village
te sin ua tjuǀho
and just went to the village
te u tza
and went and slept
te ha ju !aesi ko, ”nǀang a,
and his old people said, ”now,
itsa u tza nǀang khoma tsi ǀxoa ǁ’a dshaua nǀang e se da’ama
you two go back and sleep and in the morning come with that woman so we can see the child
ehee
yes

koe n‖ae
(they) thus said
te sa u te ha
78 *and they two went and her*
!'hoan ko, "ee, m ku tani tsi ka i tsi se ha.
husband said, "yes, we'll bring her so you can see her.
ha n|a tia g‖a'i ha |'ae te tia ǂaun
80 *indeed she was born and is growing up*
te mi ku tani tsi ka i tsi se ha"
and I'm going to bring her so that you can see her"
te
82 *and*
ha koe n‖ae te sa u tza te ‖k ae te khoma te
he thus spoke and they two went and slept and then got together again in the morning and
tza te khoma te ‖xoba
84 *slept and in the morning left*
te ka ku nǂau u sa ju !aesi tju|ho
and were going off to their old people's village
te tsi g|ae ku nǂhaoa khoe n|ui te ha
86 *and came and were walking someplace and he*
ko, "oo, |'u |'u |'u |'ua"
said, "oh, ouch, ouch, ouch, ouch"
g!u'i
88 *the anthill*
khuin |'ae tsi g!u'i oo n|anga
this is how the anthill stood
te si!a tsi g|ae ku ‖xam koa tsi ke te ha ko
90 *and they came and were walking along here and he said*
"|'u |'u |' u (?)"
"ouch, ouch, ouch (last word unclear)"
te ka n‖han ku to'a te ha
92 *and was just then going and he*
n‖aahn ‖'akaa te ko
left that and said
ya
94 *yes*
te g!xa g!oah, g!xa g!oah
and took off his shoe(s), took off his shoe(s)
te n!o'an u
96 *and threw them away*
te ko
and said

hi u du te o dxuu
they should go off and become vultures
te sa koh o dxuu sa koh taqma
and they became vultures that dropped
!ha khoea
on meat
te ǁ'a g!oah
and that shoe
tse u gea ǁ'a koa te ku
then went and stayed there (in the sky) and then
taqm te ha ko, "ye, mi
dropped and he said "hey, my
!o, !aah, !aah, !aah, !aah,
older brother, run, run, run, run,
hatce m !'ang !hun mi? n|ang a !aah n|ang
what is piercing killing me? now you run and
dxuu sa to'a a se n|ang du !ha n|ang mtsa 'm
go look at those vultures and get meat for us two to eat
te ha !o
and his older brother
te ku !aah |'an
ran after
ǁ'a, ǁ'a g!oahsa
those, those shoes
te
and
ka sa ku koh ooa
when they were doing this
ha !o ǁ'a ha dshau ǁaqma
his older brother's wife was wearing
g|xaian koe
an awl like this
te g!ai n|o te
and sewed a skin and
ka |'u n!ang ka |'ae ko ǁ'akoa
and put it up straight there
te ha ǁaqma ka te ka n!uan ha
and she put it on and it (the awl) was stuck (in the waistband)
te khuin ǁ'a !anua to'a mi koh ǁae
and it was like that metal tool I was holding
te ka ha !o !aah he g|ae ku !aah u he oo ha ko...
and when his older brother went and ran off, he...

”mi te o coea ǁ’an tzautzau to’a te ku !hun me, tzautzau, kohm, !hun mi.
(said) ”I’m going to pull out that thorn there that is killing me, a thorn, for sure, is killing me.
mi !o ǁ’a ha dshau, ha m tsi g!xa mi ko !hua ke
my older brother’s wife, pull out this thorn here”
!o ǁ’a ha dshau ku gaqea tca ju n|ui ku nǁae
older brother’s wife believed what the other person said
te tsi g|ae
and came
te ku ko ha se ka
and she was trying to look at it
te ha ko, ”ha m g|aia ka se n|ang ǁ’a a te na g|xaian to’a n|ang mi,
and he said, ”stop looking at it and just give me that awl there so I,
n|ang mi !oa a ko ka n|ang a g!xa ka”
so I can tell you about it so you can take it out”
te ha !o ǁ’a ha dshau ǂhoe ka te
and his older brother’s wife pulled it out and
|’an ha ko ka
gave it to him
te
and
te ha koe du
he thus did
koe koha koe |xoa |’an
and thus didn’t give
g|xain te...!xau
the awl...refused
te si ku, ha txun ku se
and they were, his older brother’s wife was looking at
ǁ’a g|xaian te ha
that awl and he
|’u g|xain ko koa ke
put the awl here
(stabbing sound)
(onomatop.)
te hahin, ǁ’ a dshaua, te o ǁ’a tca ǁ’a ka n|ui te ha ni !oa ha,
and this one, that woman, had done that before and had already told her,
ha txun
her grandmother
te ko, ”tca ke o tcaa
and said, ”this thing which

ǁama ka taqe n!ang he g|ai he ǁxam ka !o he tsi komm o tca mia he tam.
comes from its mother's stomach and jumps out and accompanies its older brother is a thing which I don't understand.
mi ǂ'angsi m |oa zaihn
my brains don't agree
n|ang a
now you
maq ma ku tsia a
a little wind will come to you
maq ma to'a ku tsia a, kohm,
that little wind that will come to you,in fact,
tci n|ui maq ma, kohm, ka kxae
the little wind will in fact have something
tca o |'angma ko tcia
something like a little bit of blood
te |'angma to'a kohm ku du ka tsi g|ae ǁua a ko a nǁhai
and that little bit of blood will come and stick to you on your groin
n|ang a gu |'angma to'a
now you should take that little bit of blood
te |'ua tci n!ang
and put it into something
nǁaahn kokxui, n|ang sin gu ka n|ang |'ua tci n!ang
don't speak, just take it and put it into something
tca o xabama ǁ'akaa n|a ka o |xanama"
something like a little bowl or a little jar"
ee
yes
ee
yes
te si!a ǁxoba te g|ae ku du ǁ'atca
and they left and went to do that
te ǁ'a maqma tsi !aah ua ha
and that little wind came running to his
!o ǁ'aha txun
older brother's grandmother-in-law
ku oo te ǁ'a |'angma kua tsi ǁu
was doing things and that little bit of blood came and stuck
te ha se te ko, "hatce da'amaa he, a ni !oa mi ko tca ku du?" te
and she saw it and said, "what is it that this child has already told me about things that would happen?" and
tse koe nǁaea ha !ka khoea te koe gu ka
then thus said in her heart and thus took it

”ka m, ka m, mtsa sin ku ǁama koake”
”and we, and we, we two will just go this way”
ka ha ko ”m!a u ǁ’an koa”
and she said ”let’s go over there”
eeeeeeeeeeeeeeeeeee
yes
ha n|osi khoea ka ku tsi du
on her skin it came and did
ka khoe si te g|ae gu ha ka ha
it was as if they went to get her and she
ku du ka ka |’ua ka ko |xana n!ang–
did it and put it in a jar–
tcisa to’a o Huwe, kohm, a hin ko ka dusi te n|a’ng?
those things in the Huwe (god) stories of long ago, for sure, do you here say their doings were nice?
te ǁ’akaa
and so
ǁ’aha ge te ku ǂ’ang te ko ”hin,
then she lived and thought and said ”hmm,
kaa ke mi !uma !oa mi he u he
that which my namesake told me and has now gone...
xabase si m anexa du toan tca ha koh !oaa mi te nǂoahn koara ”
although if they’ve already completed what she told me, there’s nothing to be done”
ha koe nǁae te koe nǁae
she said thus and said thus
te
and
ha g!aa !arikxaomh gesin sa o ǁ’a dshauma ǁ’aha tshin !ansin kesin !o !ansin
she went back, those other adolescents who were the girl’s younger brpthers and her older brothers
te ko, ”he, ju-he, i ya m |oo jusa he n|ang se xore
and said, ” hey, people, now go follow these people and see whether
si xae ǁau u, g!a’ama |xoa jua u he ko tju|ho”
they are going well, and have entered the village with that person over there”
koe nǁae
(they) thus said
okaa hahin ane
it was that he had already
g|ae kxoa nǁhoo ǁ’a dxuusa te |oa ho
gone and looked for those vultures and didn’t see them
te ha hin aneha koe !hun te koe tcxo te
and he had already thus killed and thus skinned and

ǁ'a tci, n|a'ng !'hae tca ku tsi
that thing, quickly when it was coming
|xoa da'a te ka ha ku'u te ku !xai tchi ǁ'a n|aia
started a fire and roasted her and were cutting up and drinking (eating) her fat
n!un te !xai tchi
stood and cut and ate
te da'ama tia n!uan koa to'a
and the child herself was standing there
te ka ha, bah, ha !o ku tsi he, oo
and when he, what, his older brother came, then
ha dshau
his wife
"dshaua o mi ma xae o kore?
"where is my wife?
te da'ama u he te o n|e'e te n!un
and that the child over there is standing alone
te ha hin |'u
and that this one has put
|'u da'a n!a'an
put a lot of wood on the fire
koe te n!un te !xai tchi n|ai xae o kaa ne?"
like this and that he is standing and cutting and eating fat, is what?"
te tsi
and came
ku n‡haoa koake te ko, "hatce xae a hin du te ka dusi koe?
was walking there and said, "what have you here done and your doings are like this?
!ha tcia ne xae to'a?"
what kind of meat is that over there?"
te ha ko, "ham nǁaahn !ha tcia ne n|ang ǁ'a a te tsi gu n|ang tshan.
and he said, "stop talking about what kind of meat it is, just come and take it and taste it.
!haa a hin kurike gu te gaqea !ha, ku gaqea dshau?"
meat you now take that you once called meat, and call it a woman?"
te ha ko "n!u n!a'an koh n!a'an"
and he said " you big penis glans" (insult)
ha, ha !xau:
he, he refused:
"a ba koe kuru te mi hin ku naun |xoa?
"how will I myself stay alive if you are doing thus?
a ba sin !hun mi, wa?
are you just killing me?
a re |xoa o jua g|ai-|'an m taqe n!ang ko tca ke koe, ǁ'ahaa tsi g|ae ku
aren't you a person who left our mother's stomach in such a way, that you have come to

koe kxuia ǀ'an mi ko dshau?"
thus ruin my wife for me?"
ko, "ham gu !ha nǀang ǁ'a a te tshan
(but he) said, "now take the meat and taste
tca ka ta'ma
what it tastes like
!ha ǀ'hoan, te kohm
plain meat, of course
ǀoa o Juǀ'hoan !ha
it's not human meat
koe !oa kxui a, nǀang a, kohm, tsi gu te
I thus tell you, so you just come and take it and
ǁ'akaa nǀang nǁhan !hun mi
and only then come and kill me
a xae
won't you
ca tshan ka ka nǁhan !hun mi?"
just taste it and only then kill me?"
si nǀa o ǁ'a tcisa ǁ'a ka nǀui nǀe'e
they certainly did one of those things
ǁ'a ha !o tsi gǀae gu ka
then his older brother came and took it
te 'm ka te ka o !ha, oo
and ate it and it was meat
te ha ko, te ha ko, "te mtsa re ku ǀxoa ka?" ka ko
and he said, and he said, "but will we two remain alive (having done this)?" and said
te ha ko "hatce re ku !'oan mtsa? mtsa m
and he said, "what will kill us, we two
ǀoa ku !ao
will not die
mi hin !'han
I know
tci nǀuia !'oan mtsa o ka koara
there is nothing that will kill us
n!anga mi khoea
stick with me
ee, mi hin khoea a n!anga"
yes, I'm the one to stick with"
!'hoan nǀang te tsau
the man sat down and then got up
te ha ko
and he said

te si kaq|'hoan ǁama ǁ'a !arikxaosa to'a te si txun !oa si te ko, "|oo ju."
and they had just come from those adolescents and their grandmother told them and said, "follow the people."
te si kaq|'hoan ǁam
222 *and they had just followed*
te ha o ǁ'a tcaa te
and he did that and
ane ha ho si te ko "si m u to'a cu te ku tsi"
224 *had already seen them and said "there they are over there, coming toward us"*
eee
yes
"n|ang a !an mi n|ang mi du |'an a ko
226 *"now wait for me and I'll do for you*
tca mi ku du n|ang a se"
something I will do and you will see"
te ha ko: "xa m du |'an mi ko ka mia he, kohm, koara tci n|uia mi !'han n|ang xa m du ǁ'a tca.
228 *and he said "now do it for me, I here for sure have nothing else that I know, so now you should do that.*
te |oa ǂ'anga mi jusi tsi !om mi"
and I don't want my people to (have to) come and bury me"
ǁxoba te g|ae, g|ae !oa
230 *left and went, went and told*
ǁ'a g!u'ia te ko
that anthill and said
"g!u'ima, !hara, n|ang mi !o g!a'ama, n!ai te ku tsi.
232 *"little anthill, break open, so my older brother can enter, a fight is coming.*
n|ang mi o n|e'e n!uan tzi"
let me stand alone outside"
mm
234 *yes*
te
and
ǁ'a g!u'ia koh
236 *that anthill*
tsharaa khoe
split in two
te ha !o g!a'ama
238 *and his older brother entered*
te ha ko "n|a a ka, !'o, !'o a, !'o a tzi"
and he said "now you should close, close your, close your door."
ǁ'a g!u'ia n|a ǁkaea khoe
240 *that anthill certainly closed together*

te ha n!un
and he stood
te si tsi te ku, te ha se si te ǀom
and they came and, and he watched them and was cutting (meat)
te si ku tsi
and they came
te ka ha tsi he n!un te o
and as this one stood there and was
m ǁ'a e !uia, ha hintsi he ǁ'a da'ama
eating and serving up our older sister , this one's child
okaa si tsi tsia, si tsi
then they came, they came
te ku tsi gǀae sin ku gu ha
and came and just took him
jua ku,
the person was,
ǁ'a ǁ'a tzamama m ge
that, that little bird exists
he koh o ǁ'a Juǀ'hoan ma m ge
and who was that little Juǀ'hoan, exists
xare ka tsi ke ha ge
even now he exists
te ka mtsa koh o jusa ku oo nǁho
and if we two were people who were travelling
ǂha sa ke o Ghanzi ǂhasi
these roads that are Ghanzi (Botswana) roads
ǁ'a ǂha sa ke m ku gǁa ku g!a
those roads we traveled (together, years ago) to get back there
ǁ'a ǂaah sa to'a
(on) those large, flat areas over there
ka koh o ju te sa
it was people and the two of them
te oo koa khoe e ku m !xoa ke, !oaakhoe
and did like we're doing, eating this pot and talking together
mi, a m ku tsa'a te ǁxoasi ǀoa !'han
I, you've heard of it but naturally don't know it
to'ma khuin to'a ka ku ko
near there it was
!'ang, !'ang, !'ang
(onomatop. bird sound)
mmm
yes

mm-mm-mm
yes
ʼin- hiin
(onomatop.bird sound
ka tzema ka ǁʼa te
it's little and then
te khu koe du, ǁʼa tzama ha hin tsi toʼa
it thus does, that bird there
ham sin o ǁʼa jua
it was just that person
te ko
and (they) say
te si tse ko "ǁomhaya" ko ha
and they call it "ǁʼomhaya"
ǁʼa Juǀʼhoansi o e gesin
those others (Naro people) who are like us Juǀʼhoansi
mi, e!a hin, e ko
I, we all here, we say
ko "ǁʼomhaya"
say "ǁʼomhaya"
ǁʼang ǁʼomhaya
(onomatop.) ǁʼomhaya
ǁʼomhaya
ǁʼomhaya
ǁʼom.....ǁʼ, ǁʼ, ǁʼ, ǁʼ
(onomatop.)
ǁʼ, ǁʼ, ǁʼ, ǁʼ
onomatop.
eeeee
yes
ee
yes
ha nǀa ku ko ǁʼang ǁʼang ǁʼang
he certainly says (onomatop.)
ǁʼom, ǁʼom
onomatop.
ǁʼom ka ǁʼaha te ku (unclear)
goes (onomatop.) and then he (unclear)
ǁʼa ha te ku khu koe g!aʼama ka ǁʼatca ha ka koe du
then he thus entered and that's what he did
te si tsi gǀae ku ǁʼan ha
and they came and were fighting him

te ha ku ǁua !u!u gǀa'a
and he perched on the point of the knife
te ku ǁua si nǀaisi
and perched on their heads
te ǁua Juǀ'hoan koa tsi ke
and perched on a person's (body part)
te si gǂxari ha
and they brushed him off
ju tzun
a person's nose
si gǂxari ha
they brushed him off
ha sin ǁxae ha
he just dodged him
te
and
ko si te ku ǁ'an ha
said they would fight him
te sintsi gǁa, gǁa, gǁa, gǁa te tlhoboga
and they just (onomatop. stabbing sound) and left off in despair
te ko, "jua he ha ǀho kuriba mi ku ho ha ka !hun a?
and said, "where will I see this person's face so I can kill him?
te ǀoa... m u
and won't ...let's leave
ha nǀa koh taahn m
he has certainly defeated us
ee
yes
oo cu," ha g!a koe nǁae
let's go lie down," he went back and thus said
te nǁaahn ha te, te gǀae sin u
and left him and and just went off
ee
yes
ǁ'akaa ha !xau te khu-gǀai
then he refused and jumped out (of the anthill)
ku gǀai te ha abasi ǁ'a !hasa te gu ǁ'a da'ama o si ma te
left and he packed up that meat and took that child of theirs and
to'a te g!a
went off and went home
si tju-ǀho
(to) their village

te
and
te
and
se te ha ko "yao,
saw and he said "yow,
itsa re g|ae kxaea kore ko
where did you two go and put that
dshaua ha da'ama to'a?"
woman whose child is over there?"
te ko, "a-o,
and said, you,
dshaua to'a...
that woman...
ka !haa mi goaq du etsa 'm he n‡haoh g!a'in,
the meat that I fixed before for you two to eat here that you are now walking around with your stomachs full of,
dshau tci tcia ne koma gea koake?"
what kind of woman could possibly be here?"
"ha m n‖aahn koe n‖ae, n‖aahn a txun, yao"
"don't say that, leave your grandmother alone, yow"
te ha ko "!ha kah ke te mi ‖ae
and he said "this is meat that I'm holding
te dshau ha o Ju|'hoandi ne re to'a?
so what Ju|'hoan woman could it be?
te da'ama hintsi i koh kxoa hintsi te etsa tsi |xoa
and this is the child you were looking for, that we two have come with
n|ang i gu"
now you take her"
te ko
and said
tsi g|ae ko, "e-e, itsa m oo tca |kau, n|ang itsa...
came and said, "no, you two have done something bad, now let the two of you...
da'amaa to'a a !oa ha ua ju sa to'a
tell that child to go to those people over there
te mi ku tsa'a khui"
and I'm in pain (over what you've done)"
te |'u te n‖a te
and discussed and talked and
‖'aha da'amaa tse ua ‖'an koa
that child then went over there
ko ha |'uisi khoea
to her in-laws' place

te si ko
and they...
te u ge te u ge te u ge te
and went and stayed and went and stayed and went and stayed and
ha ku !'am, gea ǁ'a ǀxana n!anga te !'am
it (the blood) grew, stayed in the little jar and grew
okaa ha ǀ'ua ha ko !au
then she put it in a skin bag
ka !'am ka
it grew and
du !hara ǁ'a !aua ka ha ǀ'ua ha ko hatce
split that bag so she put it into something else
ka ha !'am ka du !hara ǁ'a tca
and it grew and split that
ha hin o nǀe'e te !'han te du ka
she alone knew that she was doing that
te ju waqnsi tam
and everyone else did not know
xoana te kxae ǁ'a dshaua te du ǁ'a dshau n!a'an toan
(she) managed to keep that woman and fix that woman so she was a regular big woman again
o nǀe'e te kxae ha
she alone kept her
kxae ǁ'a ǂ'anga te ku nǂai ǁkoaa te
kept that intention and worked with it and
ka ha ku !'am ka ha ku kxoni nǁhoo ha
and she grew and she kept on fixing her
te ha ku !'am te ha ku kxoni nǁhoo ha te ha ku !'am te ha ku kxoni nǁhoo ha
and she grew and she kept on fixing her, and she grew and she kept on fixing her
te ka ha !'am ǁkae he ka tsi o dshau, hela
and when she had completely grown and become a woman, finished,
tca tsi ǀhao khuian ha tse khoe
the size of a sack is what she became like
te si ǁa'i nǀui tza
and they one day slept
te khoma te tuih te
and got up in the morning and
yaa dshausi ko si te !'hu nǀang,
the women said they would gather raisin berries,
te ǁxoba te !'hu nǀang, te da'ama ko
would leave and go gathering raisin berries, and the child said
"mi ǁa'ike ku ǁxam ǁgaqǀgaq, se ka
"I today will accompany auntie, see it

ka ’m n|ang”
and eat raisin berries”
te ha ko ”ha to’a u
and she said, ”go on and go
ǁa’i n|ui ku |oo si ka g|ae,” ha koe nǁae te nǁae
this one day you’ll follow them and go,” she said and said
te ha tsuma ǁ’a ha taqe si waqnsi ǁkaeǁkae te
and her nephew’s mother, they all got together and
!’hu u te ha hin, ǁ’a dshau n!a’an o n|e’e te gǁaan tju|ho
went off gathering and that one, the old woman was the only one who spent the day at the village
mm
yes
gǁaan, gǁaan te |am koe te ha
spent the day, spent the day, and then the sun was like this (low) and she
gu ǂoah te khara !hari te
took a reed mat and spread it in the shade and
g!oa !harisi te
in the late afternoon shadows, and
gu g!xa ha te n!anga ha ko ǁ’akoa te tsi
took her out and set her there and came and
xai g!oq’i n te |’u
ground ochre and put it on
te du kxoni ha te
and fixed her and
tsi ka ooa ka tsi ooa te
came and did it and came and did it
nǂai ǁaqma ha te nǂai ǁaqma ha te nǂai kxae ha te nǂai kxae ha te ǁ’anga ha ko ka ǂkai te (unclear)
and dressed her and dressed her and gave her (ornaments) and gave her (ornaments) and fastened copper beads (into her hair) and (unclear)
te ǂha u ǁ’ang ha te du ha te du ha (unclear)
?? hung beads on her and fixed her and fixed her (unclear)
tca |’homa o nǂangdi, !xodi
a beautiful thing, a python woman, an elephant woman
!xodi
an elephant woman
ee-ee, mi ku kokxui tama
no, I spoke wrong
ha o !xodi, mm
she was an elephant woman, yes
ha nǂangdi hin tsi to’a te si!a ku !hun ka nǂah !o!o !kaua zi tzi
the python woman was the one they killed and the buffalo thorn seed dried in her anus

si ko tca tsi o n‡angdi
they say that one was the python woman
te haa he o !xodi
but this one was the elephant woman
ee
yes
te si!a ku tsi g!a
and they all arrived
|am koe te si!a ku tsi g!a te
the sun was like this (low in the west) and they all arrived and
ha, ‖'a dshau n!a'an ku n‖ae
she, that old woman was speaking
ka ha ko, "‡hain, ‡hain, ‡haan-oo"
and she said, "(onomatop.)"
te ha da'ama tsa'a
and her child heard
te ko, "hajoe xae ku tshi ‡oa aie
said, "who is laughing like my mother
ko tju|ho?"
in the village?"
te ha g‖aq ko, "hatce xae mi !ui !ai te da'amama ku di, xae?
and her aunt said, "what is it that my older sister is dead and the little child is crazy?
ee, m !ui-m ‡xanha !ai
yes, our older sister long ago died
n|ang a n‖au ko ha te tshi kore ce"
now don't say she's laughing someplace"
te ha n|ui ko
and another one said
"hatce mi g‖aq !ai te da'ama ku di, xae?"
"what is it that my aunt died and the child is crazy?"
te ku n‡hang g|ai te
and left there and
ha tse te tshi
she laughed again
te ko "ha taqmaa-e,
said "(exclamation),
hajoe n|haisi xae?
whose laughter is this?
tca ju ani koara tju|ho, ju waqnsi tse koe !'hu, oo.
that already nobody's at the village, since everyone then thus has gone gathering.
dshauma tcia ne xae to'a te ha n|haisi ta'ma sintsi o ha |'hoan?"
what girl is that whose laughter sounds like that which is really hers?"

kaa si ku tsi g!a he oo,
then when they arrived,
se n|ang ha
388 *they saw her sitting there*
te ha n|ang te
and she sat and
te ha, ǁ'a da'ama ko, "aie xa , aie, aie, aie"
390 *and she, that child said, "it's my mother (crooning word), mother, mother, mother"*
!aah te kua tsi n‡hao te ku mq'm ha
(she) ran and quickly came and dropped down and began to nurse
ha n|a koh ku mq'm
392 *she certainly began to nurse*
tsi n|ang te mq'm
came and sat and nursed
te si ka ku se ha te ka tse ko, "yao,
394 *and they watched and said, "hey,*
hajoe xae koe koh?"
who has done this?"
"mama, n|a
396 *"granny, of course*
mama gu tsau mi
granny lifted me up
mama hin tsi nǁae te mi tsau te n|ang
398 *granny here spoke and I got up and sat*
ka ka koh i n|ang, mi ku |oa he ka ge
if it had been only you, I wouldn't be alive here
te mama hin tsi
400 *but granny here*
‡xanha gu mi
long ago took me
te |'u mi te mi ge
402 *and put me (in a bag) and I'm alive*
te
and
te tsi te ha...
404 *and came and she...*
ya ju !ae ku |xoa |'an ju"
the old people give you life"
mm
406 *yes*
teeee
and

sa ǁa’i n|ui ce te tsi te tsi ho ha te da’aba ha
they two came again another day and came and saw her and got a fright from her
ǁ’a sa sa to’a he koh !hun ha
those two who had killed her
te si gesin ko si koh...
and the others said they would...
”haa itsa koh !hun xae o haa ne te haa he xae o ha tcia ne?” te
”the one you two killed is which one, and this one is which one?” and
ha dshau n!a’an !xau
the old woman refused
te !xau he ko, ” ’in’n nǁahn koe nǁae ,
and refused and said, ”no, don’t say that,
ham sin |’an si ko ha
just give her to them
n|ang tsau g|ae kxoni ha
now get up and go get her ready
ha hin tsi ku g|ae kxoni si”
this one will go fix them”
te si ko, ”mm, n|a, a dshau n|a, a n|a ku sin gu ha”
and they said, ”mm, yes, this is certainly your wife, you certainly shall just take her”
ha tsau te ha ku ko...
she got up and he said...
|’u te zaihn ha te ǁ’a si te zaihn ha te
discussed and agreed with him and then they agreed with him and
sa hin tsi ǁkae te tza te
those two both went to sleep and
ǁ’akaa sa ku tuih he oo, ha kua tse ko, ”otca mtsa ku n‡au mi tju|ho
and then when they two had gotten up he quickly said, ”we two are going to go to my village”
te ha ko, ”ǁ’an jua m ku ko etsam ǁa’i n|ui ua tju|ho”
and she said, ”that person says we two will go this day to the village”
te si ko, ”ee oo, itsa te u oo,
and they said, ”yes, you two will go,
hatce ba o ‡o?”
what’s wrong with that?”
te sa
and they two
ǁ’a dshau n!a’an hin cete
that old woman there again
g!xa tca ke he
pulled out this thing
ka re... koa tsi ke ka ku ha ge
is it... here that still exists

gea Ju|'hoansi khoea
exists among Ju|'hoansi
koa tsi ke o ka tsi, ka re o...?
here it is, is it....?
|Ukxa N!a'an hin tsi a ku se te
Old |Ukxa here you see and
hoanah ko du ǁ'a tca
he is able to do that
o g!o'e !hua si ku du ka
with a gemsbok horn they do it,
ku dchun ka ka ka ko "aari, aari,
they blow it so it says "(onomatop.),
chaari"
(onomatop.)"
te koe nǁae, ǁ'a g!oe !hua
and thus it speaks, that gemsbok horn
si ku !hai, ee
they will wait, yes
si!a !'han ka
they all know it
ka si du ka, si du ka, ka du ka o koa tsi
when they do it, they do it, and do it over
to'a ka ka !aihn
here so it sounds
ǁ'a tca
and then
"mi ku are tcaa ke, si |oa du ka he, tci gesin si o du, |oa du ka he"
"I want that, they don't do this, that they should do other things but not this"
ǁ'a tca
and then
ha kua tsi g!xa te |'an ha !uma
she quickly took (it) out and gave her granddaughter
te ko, " gu tca ke n|ang ǁ'a te g!am
and said, "take this and then hide
!kau ka
it well
n|ang i!a u
then you all go
n|ang kaa tsi to'a i!a u u u he
then when you all have gone and gone and gone
u sao ǁkaea tju|ho
gone and all gotten near the village

he tju|ho to'm
and the village is close
a !oa sa n|ang ko, 'itsa g!a'ama tju|ho
you tell those two and say, 'you two go on into the village
mi te ku n‡au g|a'atzi, ka
I'm going to go (euphemism for) piss, am going to
n‡au tzi ka n‖han g!a'ama, n|ang
go to the bush and only then enter, so
itsa to'a,' ha koe n‖ae, 'n|ang itsa ku g!a'ama'
you two go ahead,' she thus said, 'now you two will enter'
oo n|ang a dchuun ka
do so that you can blow it
n|ang ‖'a tju|hoa !ao toan
so that village will all die
n|ang a hin ce n|ang tsi g!a
and then you can return and come here
ce n|ang tsi."
return and come back."
ha koe n‖ae
she thus said
te ha abasi te abasi te ha n‡ai abasi ha te du kxoni ha
and she packed and packed and she (grandmother) helped her to pack and fixed her up
te du kxoni te du ha te ‖auh‖auh ha
and fixed her and did her and (decorated?) her
si!a ‖xoba te g|ae u
they all left and went off
te ha ko, "da'ama tse taa ku ku !au |xoa e te a hin ku u."
and she said, " the child herself will stay with us and you will go."
te si zaihn
and they agreed
te ha ‖xoba te g|ae u
and she left and went off
ka si u u u he tju|ho ka ku to'm he oo
when they had gone and gone and gone and the village was close,
n|ang ha ku tsitsa'a si
then she asked them
n|ang a ku tsitsa'a ko
then she asked where
n!om ku cu
a mountain stood
te koa o !omm n!ang g!u ku cu te !omm koe
and where there was a riverbed with water in it and how the river was

te ha ku, te ha !oa ha te ko "mia ku tsitsa'a itsa ko tcaa
and she said, and she told him, "I'm asking you two about how
ka ǁkaekusi khuian n|ang itsa ǁau ku !oa,
the space is between (here and the village), now you two say well,
n‖ a du n!omma cu,
mention where a hill lies,
cu he ka n‡oana tju|ho oo ǁ'a n!omma hin
lies here and is like the hill of the village
tse a !ain n|ang n!uan ǁ'a n!omma khoe n|ang
and its farmroad, then stop at that hill, stop there
n|ang, n|ang du ǁ'a tca"
now, now do that (for me)"
mm
yes
te sa n‡haoh, n‡haoh, n‡haoh te ha ku n‡haoh tsitsa'a sa te sa ku !oa ha
and they two walked, walked, walked and she walked asking them things and they told her
te ko
and said
'n!omma ke he m cu,
"this hill stands here,
te !u cu te n!omma ke cu te !u cu
and a valley of soft sand lies here and this hilll stands here and this valley of soft sand lies here
te n!omma ke cu t e !u cu te n!omma tsi cu |oo
and this hill stands here and this valley of soft sand lies here and this hill here stands following
ka tsi ka o tju|hoa hin tsi to'a, ka tjusi tsi, a hin tsi te u se"
this here is the village, its houses are coming, you yourself will come and go see it,
ka da'abi !oa sa hi g!usi gaq'u he oo ku !aah n‖hoo he ku kxui tshi o"
and small children with clean tummies will be running around and playing and laughing"
ka tju|hoa hin tsi ha sa koh n‖a te ha ko, "yaq"
(she asked if that was) the village here that they two had mentioned and he said "yes"
te gu te |'u ǁ'akoa, ǁ'a okxuia
and took it and put it into her thoughts, that speech
ku n‡oahn sa te sa ce te tse !oa ha.
she went on talking to them and they two again told her things.
ka sin n‡haoh, n‡haoh ka ua khoe n|ui
and (they) just walked and walked and came to a different place
te ha ko, "kaa ke xae o kaa ne?"
and she said, " what is this (place)?"

”i’in, ka ku ha ǂxan, kohm.”
”no, it’s still far, in fact.”
”ehee”
”I see”
g|ae nǂhaoh ua ka n|ui te...”kaa ke wa ?”
went and walked to another and...”is it this one?”
”i’in, kaa o ka dore”
”no, this is a different one
te nǂhaoh te ka si ua ǁ’a n!omma oo
and walked and when they got to that mountain
te ha cete, ”te kaa ke?”
she again (said), ”and this one?”
te ha ko, sa ko, ”kaa tsi he o tju|ho ga, hin tsi”
and he said, they two said, ”this one is the one of the village, here”
te a ku se te da’abi!oa tshi u te ha gǁa te
and she watched and little children ran off laughing and she stood and
hi g!usi gaq’u te hi ku !aah nǁhoo ka kui nǁhoo
their tummies were clean and they ran around and played around
te ha ko, ”yaq”
and she said, ”yes”
te ko
and said
”ee, n|ang itsa g!a’ama,
”yes, now you two go on in,
mi ka, mi ka ku ǁkaun mi |’ae ka nǁhan g!a’ama.”
I’m going to, I’m going to powder myself and only then enter.”
te sa tse ku g!a’ama te ha
and they two then entered and she
g!xa ǁ’a tca te
took that thing out and
dchuun,
blew,
ko sa hin te ko ǁ’a jusa te si
said that these two here and said that those people and their
si tju|hosi te ku xai
their villages would be broken apart
te xai si te ǁ’a ha te
and (she) broke them apart and then she
nǂhaoh ce te.
walked back.
tcisa tsi he ha mama koh ku nǁaeh m ku tsa, he
these are the things our grandmother told us and we listened

eee
yes
ee, ha !'han tshii to'a te m!a koh goaq
512 *(story ends. beyond here is ancillary info only,so not translated)*